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# FROM THE EDITOR

It is fitting that we start this issue of the *Journal* with an article building on the legacy of the incomparable space law pioneer, Manfred Lachs, the author of the – dissenting – opinion in which the freedom of movement in outer space was put to paper. Historians will look back on the 2020s and 2030s as the "bridge" years during which humanity redefined its relationship with the cosmos and built a flexible legal lens through which to frame our relationship with each other as we wander further from our planet Earth. The *Journal* is proud to be a platform for discourse and analysis of the law as it exists today and as it should evolve to build a solid foundation for a peaceful future. Articles in this issue are as wide-ranging as the legal challenges that face humanity as we test the laws created through terrestrial custom and tradition. They address the potential of space weaponization, encourage the use of arbitration to settle disputes relating to harmful interference with radio frequencies, discuss the use of data gathered by Earth observation satellites as evidence in court rooms in the United States and suggest the development of labor law to protect space-based workers. We close with new views on space resource extraction and use, a topic with burning imminence.

This issue is also the last that we will distribute widely in paper form. There are two primary reasons that drove our decision to embrace digitization. First, as we promote the sustainability of space activities, we must also acknowledge the need to reduce our footprint here on Earth. We have accomplished this by removing both print production and delivery activities. Second, we recognize the need to disseminate the important research with which we are entrusted as widely as possible. Going digital assures that everyone, everywhere, will have access to our *Journal* for free. We offer this last print version with pride as well as humble gratitude and deep appreciation for our authors.

Michelle L.D. Hanlon
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Oxford, Mississippi